

Navid Safahieh

Department of Economics, Mitch Daniels School of Business
Purdue University, 403 Mitch Daniels Blvd, West Lafayette, IN 47907
+1 (765) 771-0021 · nsafahie@purdue.edu · navidzky.github.io

Nationality: New Zealand / Iran

On the job market 2026–27

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Transportation Economics, Search and Matching, Causal Inference

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics Expected 2027
Purdue University, Mitch Daniels School of Business, West Lafayette, IN

M.Sc. in Economics 2021
University of Tehran, Tehran, Iran

B.Sc. in Civil and Environmental Engineering 2018
Sharif University of Technology, Tehran, Iran

Dissertation Committee: Cathy Zhang (Chair), Mario J. Crucini, Chong Xiang

JOB MARKET PAPER

The Economics of Chokepoints: Remote Matching and Entry Deterrence in Global Oil Tanker Markets

Maritime chokepoints are conventionally modeled as raising only the marginal cost of transport. I argue they also act as an entry cost: because tankers are fixed remotely and days in advance, carriers choose which distant market to commit to under uncertainty about conditions on arrival, so an anticipated chokepoint restriction deters entry before any physical closure occurs — a channel that local, random-matching frameworks cannot generate. I distinguish gateways, whose closure disconnects a trading region (e.g., the Strait of Hormuz), from passages with viable substitutes (e.g., Bab el-Mandeb): gateway disruptions shift the fleet sharply and the shift persists after reopening, while passage disruptions produce gradual rerouting. Carriers withdraw from gateway-affected markets strictly before closure, and freight rates understate the cost of disruption because cargoes that attract no applicants leave no price record. The 2026 Strait of Hormuz restriction supplies the identifying episode.

PUBLICATIONS

Modeling the Accuracy of Traffic Crash Prediction Models

- *IATSS Research*, 2022. With Mohammad Hesam Rashidi, Soheil Keshavarz, Parham Pazari, and Amir Samimi.
- Models forecasting accuracy across 31 Iranian provinces using macroeconomic variables and road traffic indicators. Crash variability, average historical crash count, employment ratio, GDP per capita, and traffic exposure are the variables that affect forecast accuracy.

WORKING PAPERS

When Outside Options Shape the Labor Market: A Directed Search Perspective

- Studies how differences in outside options across workers affect wages, firm entry, and job allocation. I develop a directed search model with skilled and unskilled workers and high- and low-tech firms, where only skilled workers hold outside options. Stronger outside options raise posted wages for skilled workers but can reduce high-tech firm entry; as fewer high-tech jobs are created, skilled workers' expected wages may fall, and unskilled workers are affected indirectly through changes in firm composition and wage competition.

The Heterogeneous Effects of Exogenous Shocks on Public Transportation Demand

- With Kowsar Yousefi and Amir Samimi.
- A sudden gasoline price shock increased subway usage by roughly 3.9 percent, implying a cross-price elasticity of about 0.044, while subway usage fell by roughly 42.6 percent during the COVID-19 pandemic.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- MEA 90th Annual Meetings, Chicago, IL March 2026

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

- Estimation of Structural Models with Conditional Choice Probabilities, Notre Dame, IN Summer 2025
- 14th Annual Research Design for Causal Inference, Northwestern University, IL Summer 2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

ECON 252 Principles of Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)	Fall 2025
<i>Instructor</i>	Purdue University
ECON 252 Principles of Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)	Summer 2025
<i>Instructor</i>	Purdue University
Intermediate Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)	Fall 2025
<i>Teaching Assistant to Prof. Cathy Zhang</i>	Purdue University
Macroeconomics (PhD)	Fall 2023
<i>Teaching Assistant to Prof. Seunghoon Na</i>	Purdue University
Econometrics (Graduate)	2019 – 2021
<i>TA to Profs. Kowsar Yousefi, Atiyeh Vahidmanesh, and Alireza Oryoie</i>	University of Tehran
Game Theory (Graduate)	Fall 2019
<i>Teaching Assistant to Prof. Ghahreman Abdoli</i>	University of Tehran
Econometrics in Transportation (Graduate)	2020 – 2021
<i>Teaching Assistant to Prof. Amir Samimi</i>	Sharif University of Technology

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

- Bilsland Dissertation Fellowship, Purdue University 2026–27
- Outstanding Teaching Award (ECON 252), Purdue University Fall 2025
- Distinguished Teaching Award (ECON 252), Purdue University Summer 2025

SERVICE

- Economics Senator, Business Doctoral Students Association, Purdue University

PROGRAMMING AND DATA SKILLS

Python, R, STATA, MATLAB, Claude Code

Structural modeling, numerical equilibrium computation, simulation-based methods.

LANGUAGES

Farsi (Native), English (Fluent)

REFERENCES

Cathy Zhang (Chair)

Professor

Mitch Daniels School of Business

Purdue University

cmzhang@purdue.edu

Mario J. Crucini

Professor

Mitch Daniels School of Business

Purdue University

mcrucini@purdue.edu

Chong Xiang

Professor

Mitch Daniels School of Business

Purdue University

cxiang@purdue.edu